

Email Deliverability & Branded Domain Setup

Voice AI Demo System — contractor work order · E4L Marketing · contact: chosen1@gsgagency.com

1. Background (read first)

E4L Marketing runs an automated system that builds personalized “Voice AI receptionist” demo pages for local businesses and emails each business a link plus a live demo phone number. The emails are sent through the company's GoHighLevel (GHL) account and the demo pages are hosted on GitHub Pages. The system itself is finished and working. **Your job is only email deliverability and DNS** — outreach emails currently land in spam because the sending domain is not authenticated and the demo links use a github.io URL.

Target sub-account: a new GHL sub-account called “**E4L Agency**”. The owner is creating this sub-account and will grant you access; the location ID will be provided when access is granted. All GHL tasks below happen inside E4L Agency. Do *not* touch the separate “**E4L School**” sub-account (that one is for students and has its own sending reputation to protect).

Do not modify: anything inside the GitHub repository's code or workflow files, the GHL Voice AI agents, phone numbers, contacts, or repository secrets. Every task below happens in DNS, in GHL's email settings, or on two specific GitHub settings pages.

2. Access you will need

What	Details
GHL sub-account admin	Sub-account “ E4L Agency ” — owner will invite you. Location ID provided at invite time. Do NOT work in the “E4L School” sub-account.
Domain registrar login	For the new outreach domain the owner purchased, and for gsgagency.com if the demo subdomain will live there
GitHub repo settings	github.com/chosen1thegolden1/E4Lmarketing — Settings access for Pages and Variables (or coordinate: send the owner the two values to enter)

3. Task A — Authenticated sending domain in GHL

Goal: outreach emails send from a dedicated, SPF/DKIM-authenticated domain owned by the company — not GHL's shared infrastructure.

1. The owner purchases a dedicated cold-outreach domain (e.g. **e4lmarketingdemos.com**). Never use the primary gsgagency.com for cold email — reputation isolation is the point.
2. In GHL, switch into the **E4L Agency** sub-account → **Settings** → **Email Services** → **Dedicated Domain** (SMTP/LC Email section) → **Add Domain**. Use a subdomain for sending,

e.g. **mail.e4lmarketingdemos.com**. Confirm you are inside E4L Agency, not E4L School — the sub-account name appears in the top-left switcher.

3. GHL displays a set of DNS records (typically 2 CNAME/TXT records for DKIM, an SPF include, and a tracking CNAME). Add every record exactly as shown at the domain registrar's DNS panel.

4. Back in GHL, click **Verify**. DNS can take up to an hour to propagate; re-verify until green.

5. Set this domain as the default sending domain for the location, and set the default From name/address (e.g. "E4L Marketing <hello@mail.e4lmarketingdemos.com>").

Note: emails are sent by the system via GHL's API using the location's default email service — once the dedicated domain is the location default, the automation picks it up with no code change.

4. Task B — DMARC record

At the registrar, add a TXT record on the outreach domain:

```
Host: _dmarc | Value: v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:chosen1@gsgagency.com
```

Start with p=none (monitor). After 2–3 weeks of clean sending, tighten to p=quarantine. This record plus GHL's SPF/DKIM completes the authentication trio inbox providers check.

5. Task C — Branded demo URL (replace github.io links)

Goal: demo links in emails read as the company's own domain. Free-host links (github.io) are a spam signal and look less professional.

1. Choose the subdomain, e.g. **demos.gsgagency.com** (or demos.<outreach domain>).

2. At that domain's DNS panel, add a CNAME record:

```
Host: demos | Type: CNAME | Value: chosen1thegolden1.github.io
```

3. GitHub repo → **Settings** → **Pages** → **Custom domain** → enter the subdomain → Save. Wait for the DNS check to pass, then tick **Enforce HTTPS** (the certificate can take up to ~1 hour to issue).

4. GitHub repo → **Settings** → **Secrets and variables** → **Actions** → **Variables tab** → edit **DEMO_BASE_URL** to the new URL, e.g. https://demos.gsgagency.com — no trailing slash. (This is a Variable, not a Secret.)

5. Confirm https://demos.gsgagency.com/modernroofing/ loads the existing "Modern Roofing" demo page.

Note: after the custom domain is set, old github.io links keep redirecting, so nothing breaks.

6. Task D — Verify deliverability

1. Go to **mail-tester.com**, copy the one-time address it shows.
2. Ask the owner to run one demo with that address as the lead email (they know how), or send any email from GHL to it from the new domain.
3. Target score: **9/10 or higher**. The report lists exactly what's missing (SPF, DKIM, DMARC, blacklist, content flags) — fix and repeat.
4. Real-world check: send test demos to one Gmail, one Outlook, and one Yahoo inbox. All three should land in the Inbox (Gmail “Promotions” is acceptable; Spam is not).

7. Task E — Warm-up schedule (hand to the owner)

Period	Max outreach emails/day	Notes
Week 1	5–10	Mix in replies: answer any response quickly — replies boost reputation
Week 2	15–20	Watch mail-tester + DMARC reports for issues
Week 3	30–40	Tighten DMARC to p=quarantine if reports are clean
Week 4+	50+	Scale with list quality; stop and re-test if spam placement returns

8. Done = this checklist reads all-yes

- GHL dedicated sending domain verified (SPF + DKIM green) and set as location default
- DMARC TXT record live on the outreach domain
- demos.<domain> CNAME resolving, GitHub Pages custom domain saved, HTTPS enforced
- DEMO_BASE_URL repository variable updated to the branded URL
- https://demos.<domain>/modernroofing/ loads over HTTPS
- mail-tester score $\geq$ 9/10 from the new sending domain
- Test emails land in Inbox on Gmail, Outlook, and Yahoo
- Owner given the warm-up schedule and the new sending address

9. Key values reference

Item	Value
GitHub repository	github.com/chosen1thegolden1/E4Lmarketing
Pages site (current)	https://chosen1thegolden1.github.io/E4Lmarketing/

Repo variable to update	DEMO_BASE_URL (Settings → Secrets and variables → Actions → Variables)
GHL sub-account	E4L Agency (new) — location ID sent by owner when access is granted. Do NOT use E4L School.
Existing demo to test with	/modernroofing/ (agent “Casey”)
Owner contact	chosen1@gsgagency.com